



Part of the GANG

Ever noticed how some animals are found in a crowd? From herds of wildebeest to flocks of geese and schools of fish, some species stick together. Although it may get a bit overcrowded at times, there are advantages to being part of the gang.

WHO'S IN AND WHO'S OUT

The makeup of a group can vary between species. In some there may be a mix of males and females of different ages, or all may be of a similar age or all the same sex. In many species juveniles leave to join another group or form a new one. Female elephants, however, stay in the same group all their lives, passing on their knowledge and experience.

Safety in numbers

Life as a solitary wildebeest would be too dangerous. You immediately become a target for any lion looking for lunch. Mingle with 99 other wildebeest, and the odds of you being singled out for attack drop from 100 to 1 percent. There are also 99 other pairs of eyes looking out for predators and good places to graze. The downside is that there may not be enough food for everyone, so you have to keep moving on.

I'M THE TOP BANANA!

I do wish she'd keep up with the herd.

HERD OF WILDEBEEST

Going to war

When it comes to battling to gain space or resources, then the more warriors you have available, the better. Swarms containing thousands of pavement ants fight for territory for hours at a time, biting and wrestling their rivals. Only a few are actually killed, but the skirmishes may continue for weeks until one of the groups comes out on top and claims the territory.

SWARM OF ANTS

